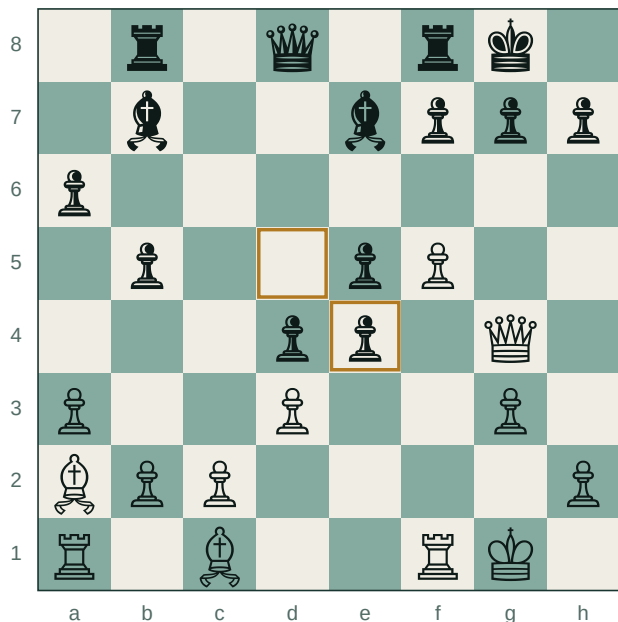


Pins and pressure: White, move 17

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 16...dxe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17. Bh6 Bf6 18. Bxg7 Bxg7 19. f6 Qxf6 20. Rxf6

17.Bh6 The bishop moves from c1 to h6. Recorded reply: **17...Bf6**.

18.Bxg7 The bishop captures the pawn on g7. From g7 it attacks rook on f8 and bishop on f6. Recorded reply: **18...Bxg7**.

19.f6 The pawn moves from f5 to f6. Recorded reply: **19...Qxf6**.

20.Rxf6 The rook captures the queen on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +6:** the balance goes from -1 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on g7 and pawn on f7.